

Exploring North Korea and AI: A Cross-Cultural English Exchange

Cross-Cultural Dialogue: From Pyongyang to AI Roleplay

Session Summary: Anatoly (Moscow) & Renee (Philippines) • Sept 02, 2026

TRAVEL SPOTLIGHT: NORTH KOREA

"The country is beautiful and prosperous... completely different from what people imagine according to mass media."

- Pyongyang Impressions:** Modern skyscrapers, clean streets, and well-maintained monasteries.
- Photo Restrictions:** Forbidden to photograph military personnel or citizens performing heavy manual labor to avoid negative internet connotations.
- Local Economy:** Observations of "Juche" (self-reliance) through domestic electric buses and a lack of visible shortages in shops.

CLIMATE CONTRAST

20°C

Moscow (Autumn)

Humid/Hot

Philippines

PARTICIPANTS

A

Anatoly (Student)

Accountant • AI Enthusiast

R

Renee (Teacher)

English Major • Volleyball Fan

SHARED INTERESTS

#FriendsTV

#TheCrown

#TheNotebook

#Movies

AI Integration in Learning

Anatoly demonstrated "Sesame," an AI tool, to roleplay *Phoebe Buffay* from *Friends*. The AI simulated a specific plotline where Phoebe is possessed by an 82-year-old spirit, testing conversational nuance.

Reading Time: ~3 mins

Full Transcript Available

This document summarizes an English language lesson between Anatoly, an accountant based in Moscow, and Renee, a teacher in the Philippines. The conversation spans a detailed firsthand account of traveling to North Korea, a comparison of regional climates, and a live demonstration of integrating AI tools into language practice.

Detailed Summary of Observations

Climate Realities and Regional Perspectives

The conversation began with a discussion on the current weather in Moscow, which Anatoly described as relatively cold for the season at +20°C, noting that this is unusual compared to previous years. They contrasted the Russian climate, often stereotyped as perpetually freezing, with the tropical humidity of the Philippines. Anatoly clarified that while winter temperatures typically hover around -7°C to -8°C, the presence of central heating makes it manageable, and extreme lows of -30°C are rare occurrences [00:57-01:3001:43-03:03](#).

A Firsthand Account of North Korean Tourism

A significant portion of the dialogue focused on Anatoly's 10-day vacation to North Korea in June 2026. He challenged common media portrayals, describing Pyongyang as a prosperous and modern city with skyscrapers and well-maintained

public spaces. Through a series of shared photographs, he highlighted various landmarks, including the monumental Pyongyang Metro, the Juche Idea monument—which emphasizes national self-reliance—and traditional Korean houses in national villages. He also noted the country's efforts in maintaining religious sites like monasteries, despite the state's official atheist stance [03:27-04:2904:58-08:58](#).

North Korea Travel Logistics

**Access:** Currently open primarily to Russian tour groups.



Format: Solo travel is prohibited; visitors must remain with a group and guide.



Currency: Tourists use USD or Yen; entry to local shops is restricted.



Photography: Generally allowed, but restricted for military personnel and manual labor.

Photography Ethics and Daily Life

Anatoly provided nuances regarding photography restrictions in North Korea. While tourists are free to take many photos, guides request that they avoid capturing military personnel or citizens performing heavy manual labor or using primitive agricultural methods (like bull-drawn plows). The intent is to prevent these images from being used in international media to create a purely negative connotation of the country's living standards. Despite these restrictions, Anatoly observed that the fields appeared well-ordered and that the general standard of living for children and urban residents seemed higher than he had previously expected [08:58-11:2612:09-13:35](#).

Personal Backgrounds and AI Integration

The participants concluded the session with personal introductions and a discussion on technology. Anatoly, an accountant with a passion for AI, demonstrated a tool called "Sesame," which allows for real-time roleplaying with AI characters. They used the tool to simulate a character from the TV show *Friends*, specifically Phoebe Buffay during a "possession" plotline from Season 2. Renee, an English major and sports enthusiast from the Philippines, noted the tool's natural-sounding output, though she observed the AI's persona felt more like a modern American woman than the specific character of Phoebe [16:00-17:4220:46-24:27](#).

Shared Media Interests	
TV Series	Movies
Friends	The Notebook

Key Data

- **Trip Duration:** 10 days in North Korea [03:43](#).
- **Trip Date:** June 2026 [15:17](#).
- **Moscow Temperature:** +20°C (Current) [01:13](#); -7°C to -8°C (Typical Winter) [02:27](#).

To-Do / Next Steps

- Renee will sift through Anatoly's full list of favorite movies to identify potential topics for future sessions [18:44](#).
- Renee plans to explore the "Sesame" AI tool to understand its capabilities for language learning [24:27](#).

Conclusion

The dialogue served as a bridge between two distinct cultures, utilizing personal travel experiences and modern technology to facilitate language learning. By moving beyond media stereotypes of both Russia and North Korea, the participants established a foundation for future discussions centered on shared interests in cinema and artificial intelligence.